

Declarer Sheet — Notrump

Bridge Habit Map

AUCTION

Habits

- ☐ Check vulnerability - use to determine aggression level in competitive auction
- ☐ Always bid to show new info - stop when no new info to show
- ☐ Use every bid to get positive and negative info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Use opps' conventional bids to show their HCP / shape
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner - HCP and shape
- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction

Strategy

- ☐ If it's our hand → bid our contract, or Dbl
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids
- ☐ We have a fit AND opps have a fit + you have length or shortage in theirs → need fewer points for game (~20) in our suit
- ☐ After you T/O and opps make a game try — don't push the bidding
- ☐ When opps bid strangely, be careful

Bids to remember

- ☐ You can reopen with a Dbl
- ☐ Bid of a minor after 4th-hand protection shows a weak 2 in that minor
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: NT from responder tends to show a max hand
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: a new suit or NT is strong
- ☐ After our Neg Dbl: a new suit is a weak 6-card suit
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → partner's Dbl is for penalties
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → Pass is a forcing pass (partner must Dbl or bid the suit again)
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → bidding the suit again shows the strongest hand

PLAN — DISCIPLINE & LEAD

Discipline

Pre-play evaluation

- ☐ Count points for us and the defenders
- ☐ Count our winners and losers
- ☐ Use info from opps' bidding and passing
- ☐ Use info from the opening lead
- ☐ Work out likely suit splits and where opps' high cards sit

Design the play

- ☐ Tricks to create = contract – winners
- ☐ Tools: ruff in short hand, create shortage for a ruff, cross-ruff, finesse
- ☐ Look for loser-on-loser elimination, squeeze, or throw-in
- ☐ Confirm entries for the planned play
- ☐ Decide when and how to draw trumps

Playing it out

- ☐ Don't be afraid to draw trumps even on a misfit
- ☐ If cross-ruffing, set up side suits first
- ☐ Play safe / the percentages — allow for 4-1 or 3-0 splits when a finesse is on
- ☐ If drawing trumps, make sure you have no suit losers in the short-trump hand
- ☐ Find losers in the long hand — discard them on dummy's winners
- ☐ In NT, if they lead your hidden 5-card suit, still play the hand properly
- ☐ If the outcome is fixed, try to fool the opps and sneak a trick

PLAN — NOTRUMP

Count

- ☐ Count sure winners (off the top)
- ☐ Work out how many extra tricks needed

Source of extras

- ☐ Pick suit(s) to develop — Force, Length, or Position
- ☐ Prefer Force when you can afford to lose the lead

Hazards & control

- ☐ How many tricks can defenders cash when in?
- ☐ Identify the danger hand — who must you keep off lead?
- ☐ Plan hold-ups to sever defensive communication